

Notation

Expression: an expression includes terms and operational symbols.

For example: $4a + 2b$. It does not include an equals sign.

Term: a term is a collection of numbers and letters. Terms are separated by mathematical symbols. For example, x^2 , $2a$, $8c$, y .

Addition and Subtraction

Top tips

$$x + x = 2x$$

$$2x + x = 3x$$

$$5a - 2a = 3a$$

However, $a + b$ will remain as $a + b$ because we can only collect like terms.

Multiplication

Top tips

$$x \times x = x^2$$

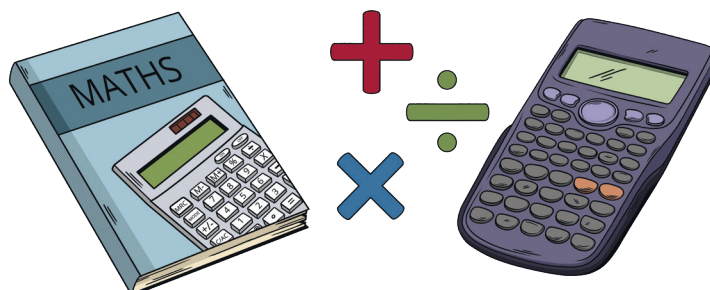
$$x^2 \times x = x^3$$

$$2x^2 \times x = 2x^3$$

$$a \times b = ab$$

$$2a \times b = 2ab$$

$$x \times y \times z = xyz$$



Division

Top tips

$a \div b$ is written as $\frac{a}{b}$

$$\frac{20b}{5b} = 4$$

because $20 \div 5 = 4$ and $b \div b = 1$

$$\frac{2a^2}{a} = 2a$$

because $2 \div 1 = 2$ and $a^2 \div a = a$